princes Sorkaktani and were known to be protectors of Christians' while Timur became known for their destruction.[§]

> And in the year fifteen hundred and seventy-six of the Greeks (a.d. 1265), in the days which introduced the Fast [of nineveh], Hulegu, King of Kings, departed from this world. The wisdom of this man, and his greatness of soul, and his wonderful actions are incomparable. And in the days of summer Tokuz Khatun, the believing queen, departed, and great sorrow came to all the Christians throughout the world because of the departure of these two great lights, who made the Christian religion triumphant.[¶]

The Mongol ruler of Persia (IlKhān), Ghazan (AD 1295–1304), converted to Islam and what followed was highly disastrous. The systematic persecution of Christians, Jews and Buddhists had become persistant and their places were destroyed at a huge pace. The initial days of Mongol rule had seen Christians being favoured extensively, but since the Islamic Conversion and after a lapse of seven decades, Islam had yet again risen as the state religion in Persia, changing things from how they were earlier.

Bar Hebraeus in his chronography describes the conditions of the Christians as extremely horrible. He writes:[*]

> No Christian dared to appear in the streets (or market), but the women went out and came in and bought and sold, because they could not be distinguished from the Arab women, and could not be identified as Christians, though those who were recognized as Christians were disgraced, and slapped, and beaten and mocked.

The persecution of Christians continued unabated under the subsequent *IlKhāns*. With the dawn of the 1340s, the Mongol power began to cease as Timur took control. Timur was clear and sound, knowing exactly what he wanted. He wanted to revive an Islamic Caliphate by hook or by crook with a definitive plan to make Samarkand the capital of Asia. One can say that he was a great conqueror concerning the parameters set in the West and the Middle East, but, in our eyes, his image was the sum of extreme brutalities. Between AD 1380 and AD 1393, Timur captured Central Asia, Persia, Egypt and the northern parts of India. By AD 1383, Baghdad, with the unabridged Mesopotamia, was completely under his control, the route to which was indeed horrific to the indigenous people. As per several accounts, Timur had made twenty towers of skulls, each having a minimum of 1500, in the ruins of Isfahan and Baghdad.[†] A few historians describe a 'systematic use of terror against towns', as 'Tamerlane's strategic element'. This was also a ploy through precedents by which he would avoid bloodshed. The widespread fear precluded any resistance as people chose to submit instead. But at the same time, his